

BRADLEY MARKLE

+1 (814) 862-8842 | bamarkle@gmail.com | Philipsburg, Pennsylvania, USA | bradleymarkle.xyz

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) in Literature and Criticism

Indiana University of Pennsylvania, Indiana, PA, USA, May 2026

Dissertation Title: *Interactivity and Interruption: Metalepsis as a Pivotal Narrative Device in Gaming*

Examines how interactive media and participatory platforms reshape authorship and narrative authority within contemporary digital culture.

Master of Arts (M.A.) in English

University of North Florida, Jacksonville, FL, USA, May 2012

Bachelor of Arts (B.A.) in English

University of North Florida, Jacksonville, FL, USA, May 2008

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Comparative Literature and World Narrative Traditions (Classical Reception, World Mythologies, and Folklore)
- Interactive Narrative and Game Studies (Metalepsis, Procedural Storytelling, and Player Agency)
- Digital Humanities and Computational Pedagogy (AI in Rhetoric and Composition, Narrative Engines, and Critical Media Literacy)
- Oral Poetics and Performance Traditions (Homeric Epic, West African Call-and-Response, and Choral Storytelling)
- African American and Southern Literatures (Southern Gothic, Afro-Caribbean Folktales, and Diasporic Narrative)
- Contemporary Print and Digital Publishing (Editorial Curation, Small-Press Production, and Student-Run Literary Journals)
- Genre Studies and American Fiction (The American Short Story, Transmedial Adaptation, and Meta-Fiction)

PUBLICATIONS

(PEER-REVIEWED)

Markle, Bradley. "Embodying the Story." First Person Scholar, University of Waterloo, www.firstpersonscholar.com/embodying-the-story/.

Sell, Mike. Modern American Drama: Voices, Documents, New Interpretations. Bloomsbury Methuen Drama, 2018. (Contributor)

(IN-PROGRESS)

Article Manuscript: Markle, Bradley. "Metalepsis and Player Agency in Interactive Media." (Article manuscript nearing submission; adapted from Chapter 1 of doctoral dissertation.)

Book Chapter: Markle, Bradley. "The Algorithmic Chorus: Oral Formulaic Performance, Classical Reception, and Computational Metalepsis in *Hades*." To be published in *Modern Meta Myths* collection. (Under Review).

- Applies Parry-Lord oral-formulaic theory and structural narratology to argue that the script engine of *Hades* acts as an automated rhapsode and algorithmic chorus, operationalizing ancient performance traditions and Orphic myth through procedural code.

Book Chapter: Markle, Bradley. "The Epistemic Elegy: Platonic Anamnesis, Knowledge-Gating, and the Resolution of Ludic Melancholia in *Tunic*." To be published in *Digital Dirges: Video Games, Elegy, and the Rhetoric of Loss* (McFarland). (Under Review / In Preparation).

- Examines classical elegiac structures and Platonic recollection (*anamnesis*) in *Tunic*, demonstrating how the game resolves cyclical melancholia and ludic grief through epistemic discovery rather than mechanical conquest.

PRACTICE-LED RESEARCH PROJECTS

Artificial Intelligence Argument Evaluator for First-year Writing Program

Developed an AI-integrated pedagogical tool to help students analyze argumentative logic and rhetorical coherence.

(argument-evaluator.vercel.app)

Narrative-Driven Interactive Prototype (Godot)

Experimental game project exploring player agency, boundary disruption, and participatory narrative structures in computational environments.

Interactive Fiction Prototypes (Twine, Inkle)

Short-form narrative experiments investigating branching design, user choice, and layered narrative.

Digital Literary Journal Production (Faculty Advisor and Production Lead, *KLIO*)

Student-run digital publication; oversee editorial workflow, multimedia integration, and web-based distribution.

TECHNICAL AND PRODUCTION COMPETENCIES

- **Web Development:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript
- **Programming:** Python, GDScript
- **Interactive Platforms:** Godot, Twine, Inkle
- **Digital Publishing:** WordPress
- **Multimedia Production:** Adobe Premiere, Adobe Audition, Adobe Photoshop, Canva

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS AND TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Associate Teaching Professor, Penn State University, August 2019 - Present

State College, PA, USA

Courses:

- English 15 (First-year Writing)
- English 202C (Technical Writing)
- English 209 (Digital Publishing Practicum): an experiential publishing practicum where students manage project development, print and digital workflows, editorial curation, and community distribution.
- Faculty advisor for three student-run literary magazines (*Kalliope*, *Folio*, and *KLIO*); directly oversee the full production cycle of *KLIO*, a digital publication, including editorial management, branding, multimedia integration, and web-based distribution.
- Mentor student editorial teams in project management, collaborative workflows, and public-facing creative production, guiding projects from submission through publication.
- Design scaffolded multimodal assignments, including interactive fiction narratives, digital rhetorical analyses, and web-based publications, that teach students to apply critical theory to academic writing and creative production.
- Incorporate interdisciplinary digital literacies across courses, drawing on game studies, film, and platform-based media to examine contemporary storytelling practices.

Temporary Faculty Instructor, Indiana University of Pennsylvania, August 2018 - March 2019

Indiana, PA, USA

Recipient of Outstanding Graduate Instructor Award

Course:

- English 101
- Gamified the learning experience by implementing an interactive, digital website where students could track their grades, progress, and assignments, fostering a more dynamic and self-directed learning environment.

Adjunct Instructor, Valencia College, October 2015 - August 2016

Orlando, FL, USA

Courses:

- Composition I
- Composition II

Adjunct Instructor, Everest University, April 2013 - August 2016

Orlando, FL, USA

Recipient of Teacher of the Year Award (2013)

Courses:

- Composition I
- Composition II
- American Literature
- Report Writing
- Founded the Everest University Newsletter and acted as Editor-in-Chief, overseeing editorial workflow and publication.

DIGITAL HUMANITIES AND OUTREACH PROJECTS

Digital Storytelling Project, Indiana University of Pennsylvania, USA (2018–2019)

Co-developed and led *Twine* workshops for local middle and high school students, bridging STEM and the Arts through interactive narrative design.

Digital Humanities Center, Indiana University of Pennsylvania, USA (2018)

Provided technical and programming support for graduate courses on digital curation, interactive narrative, and digital rhetoric; assisted students with implementation of DH tools in research projects.

Play Colloquium, Indiana University of Pennsylvania, USA (2017)

Organized panels and exhibitions exploring intersections of digital media and storytelling; led a presentation on “Old School Cool: Developing Educational Software for the Modern Instructor.”

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

SWPACA 2025 Conference, Albuquerque, NM, USA

Presentation: “Metalepsis through Player Agency: Coding, File Alterations, and Achievements in Video Game Narratives”

Drexel 2023 Conference on Teaching and Learning, Philadelphia, PA, USA

Co-presenter: “That’s the Sound of Inevitability: Using ChatGPT and other LLMs to Create Cross-Curricular Writing Assignments”

CEA 2019 Conference: Vision and Revision, New Orleans, LA, USA

Presentation: “Mario’s PTSD: Trauma and Rebirth in Popular Media”

PCA/ACA 2018 National Conference, Indianapolis, IN, USA

Presentation: “Telling Video Game Stories Through the Body: Theoretical Framework of Haptic Narrative”

Session Chair: “Gamestudies: Bodies and Controllers”

Play Colloquium 2017, Indiana University of Pennsylvania, USA

Presentation: "Old School Cool: Developing Educational Software for the Modern Instructor"

English Graduate Organization 2017 Conference, Indiana University of Pennsylvania, USA

Presentation: "Radical Trust: How Swarm Computing Can Effect Change in the Humanities"

Moderator: Literary Histories and Comics: Connecting the Now to the Then